

White-Space Map

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Unmet needs between existing offers

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

A White-Space Map plots customer needs against served segments to expose unmet needs — the 'white space' between existing offerings where new value can be created.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A strategy-and-innovation technique associated with growth strategy and with Mark Johnson's work on white space and business-model innovation.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to direct innovation toward genuinely unserved demand rather than crowded, well-contested territory.

FIGURE 1 · WHITE-SPACE MAP

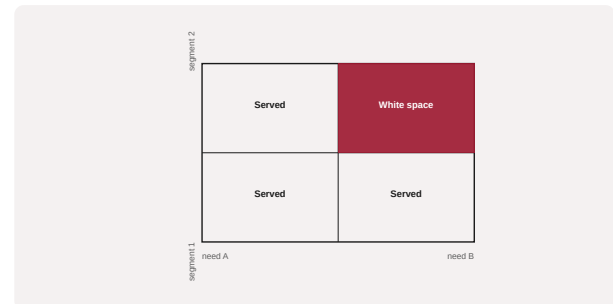


Figure 1. A schematic of the White-Space Map as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Needs and segments are crossed in a grid; cells that are important to customers yet poorly served are flagged as white-space opportunities for AI-enabled offerings.

WHEN IT IS USED

During opportunity sensing, portfolio planning and market-entry decisions.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Strategy, innovation and corporate-development teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It systematises the search for non-obvious opportunity, complementing Blue Ocean thinking with a structured needs-by-segment lens.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Demand-Signal Radar · Slibrary 4

Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas · Slibrary 4

Trend → Opportunity Funnel · Slibrary 4

Three Horizons · Slibrary 4

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Johnson, M.W. (2010) Seizing the White Space. Boston: HBR Press.

Christensen, C.M. and Raynor, M. (2003) The Innovator's Solution. Boston: HBS Press.